

```
uidNumber: 500
gidNumber: 501
homeDirectory: /home/vbg
```

We will also need to store user groups in LDAP. The script to migrate the group file is *migrate_group.pl*:

```
[root@vbg migration]# ./migrate_group.pl /etc/group /tmp/group.ldif
```

For the sake of simplicity, we can combine the three files into one:

```
[root@vbg migration]# cat /tmp/group.ldif >> /tmp/base.ldif
[root@vbg migration]# cat /tmp/users.ldif >> /tmp/base.ldif
```

We now need to simply import this LDIF into our directory, and configure a Linux system to use this LDAP as the authentication mechanism.

```
[root@vbg migration]# ldapadd -x localhost -D "cn=Manager,dc=knaif,dc=org"
-W -f /tmp/base.ldif
Enter LDAP Password:
```

Once the entries have been added in your LDAP server, it is time to configure the client to use LDAP. On the client system, execute the *authconfig-tui* utility. Make sure that you perform the operations listed below on client systems:

```
[root@vbg-work ~]# authconfig-tui
```

Make sure that you select (by pressing the space bar) the following (refer to Figure 1):

1. In the User Information Column, Use LDAP.
2. In the Authentication Column, Use LDAP Authentication. Press 'Next'. On the next screen, set your *ldapserver* and *baseDN* information (refer to Figure 2) and press OK.

On the client, check whether the entries from the LDAP server are reflected in the password database:

```
[root@vbg-work ~]# getent passwd
```

You will see an entire list of entries. The entries at the top are from the local */etc/passwd* file, and the ones after that are from LDAP, as you can see from the output.

Try logging in on the client as a user created in the central LDAP:

```
[root@vbg-work ~]# su - vbg
su: warning: cannot change directory to /home/vbg: No such file or directory
-bash-4.0$ logout
```

This is great! Our efforts have succeeded and we have logged into a user created in LDAP—vbg. Since this user was not created by the *useradd* command on the local system (client), the client does not have the user's home directory.

I hope using LDAP for centralised authentication on Linux clients is clear to you. As we have seen, this creates a problem when the user's home directory is not present on the local system. To allow any user in the network to log in from any terminal (i.e., as a roaming profile), we will need to provide each user with a home directory. In the next article, we will use *auto-mounter* (*autofs*) using LDAP, to automatically mount a user's home directory on a remote system and provide a centralised authentication system with roaming profiles for Linux clients using LDAP.

I hope you have enjoyed this article. Do feel free to clear any doubts that you might have. **END** 

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